Sameer Alam

Technical Support Professional at IBM | DevOps, SRE, Platform Engineering, Python Automation, Kubernetes, Ansible, CI/CD

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Profile Summary

Technical Support Professional with **8+ years of experience** across Linux/Unix administration, enterprise technical support, DevOps, automation, and cloud-native operations. Focused on saving engineering time by automating repetitive work with **Shell**, **Python**, and **Ansible** while supporting secure, reliable, and scalable infrastructure.

Current stack includes **Python Automation**, **Python FastAPI**, **Python DSA**, **Ansible Playbooks**, and **Shell/Python scripting** with hands-on work in **Docker**, **Podman**, **kind**, **Kubernetes**, and **GitHub Actions**. I am also deepening my platform engineering skills through OpenShift sandbox labs, weekend study in system design and Kubernetes, regular CNCF / DevOps / SRE event participation, and building AI chat, agent, and GitHub bot workflows hosted on Render.

Work Experience

Technical Support Professional - IBM (Jun 2021 - Present)

- Provide enterprise technical support and platform operations for **500+ servers** across RHEL, AIX, SUSE, Ubuntu, Debian, and Windows Server environments, contributing to stable service delivery and faster issue resolution.
- Automate repetitive operational tasks with **shell scripts**, **Python scripts**, and **Ansible playbooks**, improving turnaround time for patching, health checks, and standard support activities.
- Designed and maintained automation for **SSL certificate lifecycle management**, reducing manual effort and helping teams standardize certificate renewal and deployment processes.
- Work daily with **Docker**, **Podman**, **kind**, and **Kubernetes** while deepening container platform engineering capabilities through OpenShift sandbox labs and local macOS environments using Rancher Desktop.
- Support monitoring, problem determination, and **root cause analysis** using Nagios, API monitoring tools, Prometheus, Grafana, logs, and system-level troubleshooting practices.
- Contribute to CI/CD and deployment automation with **GitHub Actions**, Git-based workflows, and scripting support for containerized and microservice-oriented environments.
- Act as a technical advisor within the current project by contributing runbooks, documentation, operational guidance, and automation ideas that improve team productivity and system reliability.
- Drive continuous learning in **platform engineering**, **OpenShift**, **CI/CD**, and **AI-assisted automation**, including chat and agent integrations to reduce repetitive support effort.

System Engineer - EY (Feb 2020 - May 2021)

- Delivered high-quality application support for enterprise systems built on **PHP, Java, and web technologies**, diagnosing production issues and implementing fixes that reduced system downtime by **30%**.
- Implemented enhancements, modified existing codebases, and developed internal tools to improve system efficiency and troubleshooting capabilities.
- Reviewed and updated legacy application modules, optimized logic, and implemented improvements to maintain stability and performance across business-critical applications.
- Managed frequent manual deployments and production updates including HTML/UI changes, configuration updates, and hotfix releases.
- Collaborated with developers, QA, and infrastructure teams to troubleshoot issues, validate fixes, and ensure smooth production releases.

System Engineer - Netsoft Consulting Services (P) Ltd (Dec 2018 - Feb 2020)

- Provided technical support and maintenance for enterprise software applications, troubleshooting production issues and ensuring minimal downtime for business operations.
- Assisted in debugging and resolving issues across **PHP, Java, and web-based applications** while coordinating with development teams for code fixes.
- Performed application updates including HTML/UI modifications, configuration adjustments, and patch deployments across multiple environments.
- Installed, configured, and maintained diverse software applications and operating systems while ensuring system reliability and performance.

Solutions Engineer - Quatrro (May 2018 - Dec 2018)

- Provided proactive remote technical support for US-based customers, resolving system and application issues while maintaining high customer satisfaction.
- Configured Microsoft Outlook, email systems, and performed efficient hardware/software troubleshooting to resolve end-user challenges.
- Diagnosed network, application, and operating system issues, ensuring timely resolution and stable system performance.

Education

- **MCA** - Jain University, Bangalore (2024)
- **BCA** - Magadh University (2017)

Key Skills

Strong fit for container and platform-focused roles requiring Kubernetes fundamentals, Linux administration, Git-based workflows, automation with Shell/Python/Ansible, CI/CD delivery, problem determination, root cause analysis, Agile collaboration, and clear written and verbal communication.

Python Automation | Python FastAPI | Python DSA | Shell Scripts & Python Scripts | Ansible Playbooks | Linux / Unix Administration | Kubernetes | Kubernetes Microservices Deployment | Docker | Podman | kind | Rancher Desktop | OpenShift (Learning) | Platform Engineering | GitHub Actions CI/CD | Jenkins / Travis CI | Git & GitHub | Root Cause Analysis & Debugging | Prometheus & Grafana | Nagios & API Monitoring | SSL Certificate Lifecycle Automation | AI Chat & Agent Automation | Agile / Jira | ServiceNow | Technical Advisory & Documentation

Projects

- **SecureExamPortal:** Secure online exam portal built for the MCA project with authentication, monitoring, and exam integrity checks for safer online assessments. GitHub
- **llm-dev-kit:** Local LLM and RAG development toolkit using Ollama, Streamlit, ChromaDB, and Redis for prompt experiments, PDF workflows, vector search, and Docker-ready AI development. GitHub
- **ipmg:** Enterprise-ready Python CLI for IP management and ping monitoring with parallel network scanning, subnet discovery, hostname resolution, scheduled checks, and XLSX/CSV/JSON reporting. GitHub
- **Monitoring:** Docker-based monitoring stack for Linux containers using Prometheus, Grafana, Node Exporter, and cAdvisor to improve infrastructure visibility and troubleshooting. GitHub
- **ansible-smart-os-health-check:** Agentless Ansible playbook that collects Linux server CPU, memory, disk, process, and user metrics and generates a clean HTML health report without requiring Prometheus or Grafana. GitHub
- **KubeRescue:** Autonomous Kubernetes failure detection and policy-driven auto-remediation engine designed for SRE workflows and faster recovery from platform incidents. GitHub
- **ansari:** Advanced native scripting project for automated resource integration, reflecting my ongoing work on reusable automation patterns and developer productivity tooling. GitHub
- **ComputeCentral Blog:** Ongoing DevOps, SRE, and platform engineering blog where I publish practical notes, automation learnings, and hands-on experiments from my daily work and weekend deep dives. Website

Certifications

- Monitor and Manage Google Cloud Resources Skill Badge - Google (Oct 2024)
- The Basics of Google Cloud Compute Skill Badge - Google (Oct 2024)
- AWS Knowledge: Cloud Essentials - AWS (Jan 2024)
- AWS Knowledge: Architecting - AWS (Oct 2023)
- Pen Testing, Incident Response & Forensics - IBM (Sep 2023)
- Networking Essentials - Cisco (Feb 2023)
- AWS Cloud Quest: Cloud Practitioner - AWS (Dec 2022)
- Docker Essentials: A Developer Introduction - IBM (Nov 2022)
- Cloud Core - IBM (Sep 2021)
- IBM Cloud Essentials - IBM (Sep 2021)
- Cybersecurity Essentials - Cisco (Nov 2020)
- Introduction to Cybersecurity - Cisco (Nov 2020)
- Apsara Clouder - Cloud Computing Specialist Certification - Alibaba Cloud (Oct 2020)
- CyberArk Certified Level 1: Trustee Exam - CyberArk (Oct 2020)
- CEFR level B1 - British Council (Jun 2020)
- Digital Marketing - Accenture (Jun 2020)
- NSE-1 Network Security Associate - Fortinet (May 2020)
- NSE-2 Network Security Associate - Fortinet (May 2020)
- Security Certified Network Specialist (SCNS) - DefensityOne (May 2020)
- Amazon Web Services Solutions Architect Associate - Udemy (Apr 2020)
- Masters of Network Administrations-MNA - Jetking Infotrain Limited (Apr 2018)
- C Programming - Spoken Tutorial, IIT Bombay (May 2016)